ENGLAND FOOTBALL

FACILITIES PILLAR · HELP & SUPPORT GUIDE

Facilities

Everything currently available to help clubs improve, fund, run and look after their pitches and facilities.

How to use this guide: each numbered block is one source of support. Text in **green ›** is a link you can click to open.

1 Facilities guidance

ENGLAND FOOTBALL

By 2028, The FA's ambition is to deliver **12,000 quality grass pitches** and **300 more 3G artificial grass pitches**. The FA and the Football Foundation offer tools, funding and guidance for new 3G pitches, changing room upgrades, grass pitch improvements and community facility ownership, backed by The FA's technical standards on everything from pitch dimensions to goalpost sizes. **Go to Facilities Guidance ›**

PDF GUIDE
Pavilion and Changing Room Guidance ›
Designing changing and welfare accommodation, for new builds, refurbishments or extensions.

PDF GUIDE
Pitch and Goalpost Safety ›
Recommended goalpost sizes and pitch markings for different forms of the game.

PDF GUIDE
Grass Pitch Use During Drought ›
Helps clubs, leagues and match officials assess risk and manage pitch use in drought or very dry conditions.

EXTRA INCOME
Host an InPost locker ›
A steady income stream for the club that drives footfall, at no cost to the club.

2 Funding for facilities

FOOTBALL FOUNDATION

The Football Foundation, funded by the Premier League, The FA and Government, holds the investment for new and existing grassroots facilities. Its grants are flexible: click any programme below for details. **See all funding ›**

PITCHES
- 3G Pitches
- Grass Pitch improvement
- Creation of new grass pitches
- Grass Pitch Drainage
- Small-sided facility improvements

BUILDINGS & SITE
- Changing Pavilions & Clubhouses
- Catering Units
- Storage Containers
- Fencing
- Portable floodlights

EQUIPMENT & SAFETY
- Goalposts
- 3G Pitch Maintenance Machinery & Equipment
- Grass Pitch Maintenance Machinery & Equipment
- Premier League Defibrillator Fund

PROGRAMMES
- PlayZones
- Hubs
- Active Through Football
- Lionesses HERe to Play Fund
- Premier League Stadium Fund

Not funded: facilities not available for community use, kit and equipment, projects for private gain, projects outside England, retrospective funding, routine maintenance and repairs, and facility hire.

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3 Community Engagement Toolkit

FOOTBALL FOUNDATION

Helps clubs applying for funding work with local people to plan community football and multi-sport projects, and reach four priority groups: lower socio-economic groups, women and girls, people with disabilities, and culturally diverse communities. **Open the toolkit ›**

FIVE STAGES OF ENGAGEMENT

STAGE 1	STAGE 2	STAGE 3	STAGE 4	STAGE 5
Making a plan	Building partnerships and narrowing the focus	Making connections	Developing plans	Staying connected

Also in the toolkit: a Community Engagement Log to record progress, multi-sport advice, and guidance by **facility type** (PlayZones, changing pavilions, 3G pitches, grass pitches) and by **priority group**.

4 The Greener Game

WITH E.ON NEXT

A free programme from England Football and E.ON Next for 2* and 3* accredited clubs, whether or not they own their facilities. It helps clubs cut energy use and bills and reduce their environmental impact.

- **Free energy support pack:** choosing a deal, using your meter and more **Request ›**
- **Free smart meter** for existing E.ON customers, with priority for members: **greenergame@thefa.com**
- **Expert guidance,** season-long campaigns and club case studies.
- **Free energy audits:** the 2026 application window closed on 31 July.

Join the programme › **About the Greener Game ›**

5 Saving energy

FOOTBALL FOUNDATION

Practical ways for a club to deal with rising energy costs.

- **No-cost first:** switch off lights, heating and appliances when not in use; heat rooms to about 18°C; wash kit at 40°C or below.
- **Quick wins:** seal draughts, insulate, check your tariff and set floodlights to the lux level each activity needs.
- **Bigger projects:** LED floodlights use about 60% less energy, plus solar panels, heat pumps and biomass boilers. Take professional advice first.
- **Consider a Sustainability Officer** to lead on suppliers, communication and projects.

Read all the energy-saving tips ›

6 Workshops and guides

IN THE PLAYBOOK

Log in to the PlayBook to find the resources below. **Open the PlayBook ›**

WORKSHOP

3G Pitch Activation Workshop

Helps clubs understand the opportunities, requirements and considerations of a 3G pitch project. Introduces Football Foundation investment, how 3G can grow participation and wider community outcomes, and whether a 3G pitch fits the club's long-term ambitions.

WORKSHOP

Facilities Grass Pitches Workshop

Helps clubs improve the quality, sustainability and playability of their grass pitches. Covers why grass pitches matter, common pitch challenges, and the tools, funding and support available.

GUIDE

Home Advantage Programme

Explains this Football Foundation programme, which supports clubs to secure long-term leases or community asset transfers of council-owned facilities: its purpose, funding, support, stakeholder roles and the process to follow.

REFERENCE GUIDE

Facilities and Investment Technical Expertise

An overview of facility investment through The FA and Football Foundation: key programmes, funding streams, eligibility and support, to help clubs plan development, investment and long-term sustainability.